

AP HuG

Unit 1: Thinking Geographically



Developing Understanding

BIG IDEA 1

Patterns and Spatial Organization **PSO**

- Why do geographers study relationships and patterns among and between places?

BIG IDEA 2

Impacts and Interactions **IMP**

- How do geographers use maps to help them discover patterns and relationships in the world?

BIG IDEA 3

Spatial Processes and Societal Change **SPS**

- How do geographers use a spatial perspective to analyze complex issues and relationships?

This first unit sets the foundation for the course by teaching students how geographers approach the study of places. Students are encouraged to reflect on the “why of where” to better understand geographic perspectives. Many other high school courses ask students to read and analyze data, but for this course, students also apply a spatial perspective when reading and analyzing qualitative and quantitative data.

Students learn the ways information from data sources such as maps, tables, charts, satellite images, and infographics informs policy decisions such as voting redistricting or expanding transportation networks. They also learn about how people influence and are influenced by their environment; the resulting impact on topography, natural resources, and climate; and the differences between and consequences of environmental determinism and possibilism.

Finally, students are introduced to the language of geography, learning discipline-specific terminology and applying that language to contemporary, real-world scenarios so they can better study population processes and patterns in the next unit.

Important Dates/Reminders:

Unit 1: Thinking Geographically

Topic	Learning Objective(s)	Essential Knowledge
1.1 Introduction to Maps	Identify types of maps, the types of information presented in maps, and different kinds of spatial patterns and relationships portrayed in maps.	Types of maps include reference maps and thematic maps. Types of spatial patterns represented on maps include absolute and relative distance and direction, clustering, dispersal, and elevation. All maps are selective in information; map projections inevitably distort spatial relationships in shape, area, distance, and direction.
1.2 Geographic Data	Identify different methods of geographic data collection.	Data may be gathered in the field by organizations or by individuals. Geospatial technologies include geographic information systems (GIS), satellite navigation systems, remote sensing, and online mapping and visualization. Spatial information can come from written accounts in the form of field observations, media reports, travel narratives, policy documents, personal interviews, landscape analysis, and photographic interpretation.
1.3 The Power of Geographic Data	Explain the geographical effects of decisions made using geographical information.	Geospatial and geographical data, including census data and satellite imagery, are used at all scales for personal, business and organizational, and governmental decision-making purposes.
1.4 Spatial Concepts	Define major geographic concepts that illustrate spatial relationships.	Spatial concepts include absolute and relative location, space, place, flows, distance decay, time-space compression, and pattern.
1.5 Human-Environmental Interaction	Explain how major geographic concepts illustrate spatial relationships.	Concepts of nature and society include sustainability, natural resources, and land use. Theories regarding the interaction of the natural environment with human societies have evolved from environmental determinism to possibilism.
1.6 Scales of Analysis	Define scales of analysis used by geographers. Explain what scales of analysis reveal.	Scales of analysis include global, regional, national, and local. Patterns and processes at different scales reveal variations in, and different interpretations of, data.
1.7 Regional Analysis	Describe different ways that geographers define regions.	Regions are defined on the basis of one or more unifying characteristics or on patterns of activity. Types of regions include formal, functional, and perceptual/vernacular. Regional boundaries are transitional and often contested and overlapping. Geographers apply regional analysis at local, national, and global scales.

Chapter 1: Introduction to Human Geography Unit 1: Thinking Geographically Questions/Main Ideas:	Name: _____ Class: _____ Period: _____ Notes/Answers:
Field Note (pg. 1 - 4)	
What fraction of the world's population is malnourished? Why do you think it is that women and children suffer the most?	
Look at the maps on pg. 2 & 3. Comment on <u>two</u> of the patterns you observe on the maps and hypothesize as to why those patterns may exist.	
What are the three major causes of malnourishment?	
According to the text, Bangladeshis are malnourished despite having 70% arable land; whereas Norway has only 4% arable land and are well-fed. Explain why Norway manages to be well fed.	
Why do Kenyans continue to grow Coffee & Tea, instead of food staples like grains?	
Look at the maps on pg. 3 & 4. Is there a relationship between a state's wealth and their arable land? Why or why not?	

Key Question #1: What is human geography? (pg. 5)

What four areas does the field of Human Geography focus on?

What is globalization?

How can it be seen at scales ranging from local to global?

Key Question #2: What are geographic questions? (pg. 5 - 11)

Explain the similarities and differences between human geography and physical geography?

What questions do Marvin Mikesell and others ask in regard to the definition of geography?

To think geographically, one must think of the spatial arrangement and distribution of a phenomenon.

Apply this idea to Snow's cholera map.

How did Snow figure out Cholera was a waterborne illness?

What does this explanation have to do with geography?

In 1991 and 2010, there were Cholera outbreaks in Peru and Haiti, respectively.

What does this have to do with geography?

Why do you think this ancient disease still plagues certain parts of the world?	
List and briefly describe the Five Themes of Geography.	
Compare the maps on pg. 8 & 9. What trends do you observe?	
Which social scientist is associated with the term <i>cultural landscape</i> ? How does he define it?	
What evidence do we see of cultural landscapes?	
Define Sequent occupance. How is Dar es Salaam an example of sequent occupance? What is another example of sequent occupance?	

Key Question #3: Why do geographers use maps, and what do maps tell us? (pg. 11 - 17)	
Define absolute location. What are some practical uses for absolute location?	

Define Relative Location. What are some potential problems with using relative location to find, for example, someone's home?	
Describe GPS	
Describe your activity space on a typical weekday. How is this different than Mental Maps?	
How is the map on pg. 14 & 15 an example of a generalized map? How might this map, and other generalized maps, be misleading?	
Describe Remote Sensing technology. What does it allow us to do?	
Describe Geographic Information Systems (GIS). What does GIS allow Geographers to do? Give an example of GIS from the text.	

Key Question #4: Why are geographers concerned with scale and connectedness? (pg. 18 - 26)

Across what four scales do geographers study places and patterns?	
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What are the two meanings of scale in geography? Which are we most concerned with?	
Using the text on page 18 and Figures 1.3, 1.16, and 1.17, explain the importance of scale (what each scale reveals and the limits of those scales).	
Describe jumping scale .	
What danger does Victoria Lawson describe with <i>jumping scale</i>?	
What constitutes a region?	
Define & give an example in the area you live of a: 1. Formal region 2. Functional region 3. Perceptual/Vernacular region	
Define & give an example of a 1. Culture 2. Culture trait 3. Culture complex 4. Cultural Hearth What is the difference between culture trait and complex?	
Define Cultural Diffusion.	

Define time-distance decay and explain how it impact cultural diffusion.	
Define cultural barriers and explain how they can impact cultural diffusion.	
Define and give an example of expansion diffusion.	
Define and give examples of the following types of expansion diffusion: 1) Hierarchical diffusion 2) Contagious diffusion How are they similar? How are they different?	
How are Indian hamburgers an example of stimulus diffusion, an type of expansion diffusion?	
Define Relocation Diffusion. How does it most frequently occur?	
Key Question #5: What are geographic concepts, and how are they used in answering geographic questions? (pg. 26 - 28)	
What are the steps to thinking geographically?	
Define environmental determinism. Explain how environmentally deterministic theories that explain Europe as "superior" to the rest of the world ignore certain facts of history?	
Define Environmental Possibilism. How is it different than environmental determinism?	